

Functional, Non Functional and Domain Requirements

These requirements are raw as of now, changes will be made to them once we get answers to our elicitation questions.

1. Guest User

Functional Requirements

Derived from Survey + Observation

1. The system shall allow users to browse all events without creating an account or logging in
2. The system shall display a city selector prominently on the homepage before showing any events
3. The system shall show trending and featured events on the homepage based on the detected or selected city
4. The system shall allow users to search events by name, genre, or city without login
5. The system shall allow users to filter events by date, price, language, and venue without login
6. The system shall display complete event details — price, timing, cast/lineup, venue, and seat availability — without requiring login
7. The system shall redirect users to login or registration only when they attempt to book a ticket
8. The system shall allow users to register via email/password or Google OAuth or Mobile number from any point in the browsing flow

Non-Functional Requirements

1. The homepage must load within 2 seconds on a standard mobile connection
2. Search results must appear within 2-3 second of query submission
3. The system must not store any personally identifiable information for guest sessions

4. All pages must be fully functional and readable on mobile screens without horizontal scrolling
5. The city selector must be visible within the first viewport on homepage load without scrolling

2. Registered User

Functional Requirements

Derived from Survey + Interview

1. The system shall allow users to login via email/password, Google OAuth, or mobile number OTP
2. The system shall allow users to set and update preferences — favourite genres, artists, and cities — from their profile
3. The system shall generate personalized event recommendations based on booking history, set preferences, and browsing behavior
4. The system shall display an AI-generated review summary on every event detail page, accessible without login
5. The system shall display an AI-generated summary of critic and audience reviews on every event detail page
6. The system shall allow users to follow specific artists or venues and receive notifications when they list new events
7. The system shall provide an interactive seat map showing real-time seat availability with color-coded pricing tiers
8. The system shall temporarily lock selected seats for a user from selecting seats till checkout and also keep it reserved till 5 minutes of user inactivity to prevent simultaneous booking by another user
9. The system shall support payment via UPI, credit/debit card, and net banking
10. The system shall send booking confirmation within 5 seconds of successful payment via email, SMS, and in-app notification
11. The system shall generate a downloadable e-ticket with a unique QR code for each confirmed booking

12. The system shall maintain a booking history accessible from the user dashboard
13. The system shall allow users to cancel a booking and initiate a refund subject to the event's cancellation policy
14. The system shall send event reminders to users 24 hours and 2 hours before the event
15. The system shall allow users to rate and review an event after the event date has passed
16. The system shall display a fallback of trending or popular events along with the personalized recommendations and also when personalized recommendations cannot be generated
17. The system shall provide users the ability to download or export their booking history on request — data portability right
18. The system shall prompt registered users to confirm they meet the minimum age requirement before completing a booking for any age-restricted event, and must display the restriction clearly on the event detail page prior to checkout.

Non-Functional Requirements

1. Seat locks during checkout must be maintained for a minimum of 5 minutes — released automatically if payment is not completed
2. No two users shall be able to successfully book the same seat for the same show — concurrent booking conflicts must be handled at the database level
3. Payment processing must comply with PCI-DSS standards — no raw card data shall be stored on the platform
4. User passwords must be stored using bcrypt hashing — plaintext storage is strictly prohibited
5. Personalized recommendations must load within 3 seconds — falling back to trending events if the LLM API does not respond within that window
6. Booking confirmation must be delivered within 5 seconds of payment success

7. The system must support a minimum of 500 concurrent users during peak booking periods without performance degradation
8. User sessions must expire after 30 minutes of inactivity
9. Users must be able to request complete deletion of their account and associated data

3. Theatre Management

Functional Requirements

FR1. Movie/Event Management :-

The system shall allow authorized management staff to add, update, and remove movie or event details such as title, description, duration, genre/category, language, and other relevant information.

FR2. Show Scheduling

The system shall allow management staff to create and manage show schedules by specifying the movie/event, date, time, theatre, and screen.

FR3. Theatre and Screen Management

The system shall allow management staff to add, update, and manage theatres and their screens.

FR4. Seat Arrangement Management

The system shall allow management staff to define and manage seating arrangements for each screen, including different seat categories.

FR5. Ticket Price Management

The system shall allow management staff to set and modify ticket prices for different seat categories and shows.

FR6. Show Modification

The system shall allow authorized staff to modify the details of an existing show, including its timing, screen, and ticket pricing.

FR7. Show Cancellation and Rescheduling

The system shall allow authorized staff to cancel or reschedule a show and shall handle existing bookings associated with the affected show.

FR8. Booking Management

The system shall allow management staff to view and manage bookings associated with movies/events and shows.

FR9. Seat Availability and Double-Booking Prevention

The system shall maintain the booking status of seats and prevent the same seat from being booked more than once for the same show.

FR10. Scheduling Conflict Detection

The system shall detect and prevent conflicting show schedules for the same screen.

FR11. Booking Information Management

The system shall maintain relevant booking information such as show, customer, selected seats, booking status, and ticket details.

FR12. Occupancy Monitoring

The system shall calculate and display the occupancy of each show based on the number of booked seats and available seats.

FR13. Revenue Monitoring

The system shall calculate and display revenue generated from ticket sales for movies/events and shows.

FR14. Management Dashboard

The system shall provide a management dashboard displaying important statistics such as bookings, occupancy, ticket sales, and revenue.

FR15. Reports

The system shall generate reports related to movie/event performance, ticket sales, occupancy, bookings, and revenue.

FR16. Access Control

The system shall provide role-based access so that only authorized members of the management team can perform administrative operations.

Non Functional Requirements:-

NFR1. Performance

The system should respond to management operations such as viewing schedules, updating shows, and retrieving reports within a reasonable time.

NFR2. Reliability

The system should reliably maintain accurate movie, show, seating, booking, and revenue information without unintended data loss.

NFR3. Data Integrity

The system shall maintain consistency between show schedules, seat availability, bookings, ticket prices, occupancy, and revenue records.

NFR4. Security

The system shall protect management data and restrict administrative operations to authorized users.

NFR5. Usability

The system should provide a simple and clear interface so that management staff can easily manage movies, shows, theatres, seats, bookings, and reports.

NFR6. Availability

The system should be available whenever management staff need to perform movie, event, show, and booking management activities.

NFR7. Scalability

The system should be capable of handling an increasing number of movies/events, theatres, screens, shows, seats, and bookings without significant degradation in performance.

NFR8. Maintainability

The system should be designed so that movie management, scheduling, pricing, booking, and reporting features can be modified or enhanced without major changes to the entire system.

NFR9. Accuracy

The system should accurately calculate and display booking counts, seat occupancy, ticket sales, and revenue.

NFR10. Auditability

The system should maintain records of important management actions such as show creation, modification, cancellation, rescheduling, and price changes.

4. Concert Management

Functional Requirements

FR1. Browse Live Events

The system shall allow customers to browse available and upcoming live events.

FR2. Event Creation and Management

The system shall allow authorized event managers to create and manage live events. Only authorized event managers should be able to perform these operations.

FR3. Artist and Performer Management

The system shall allow event managers to maintain information about artists and performers. The system should allow the event manager to update the lineup if there are changes before the event.

FR4. Seat/Area Selection

For concerts that use assigned seating, the system shall display the available seating arrangement. For standing concerts, the system can instead show available ticket categories and remaining capacity.

FR5. Real-Time Ticket Availability

The system shall maintain the current availability of tickets. The system shall ensure that availability shown to customers remains consistent with the actual booking database.

FR6. Prevent Double Booking and Overbooking

The system shall prevent multiple customers from booking the same seat or exceeding the available capacity. When multiple customers attempt to book the same ticket simultaneously, the system shall ensure that only one successful booking is created for that ticket. If a selected ticket becomes unavailable during

checkout, the system shall inform the customer and require them to select another available ticket.

FR7. Digital Ticket Generation

The system shall generate a digital ticket for every confirmed booking. The ticket shall contain a unique identifier or QR code. The system shall prevent the same ticket from being successfully used more than once.

FR8. Event Cancellation and Rescheduling

Authorized event managers shall be able to cancel or reschedule concerts.

If an event is cancelled, the system shall:

- Stop new bookings.
- Mark the event as cancelled.
- Identify affected bookings.
- Inform customers.
- Initiate refunds according to the applicable policy.

If an event is rescheduled, the system shall:

- Update the event date/time.
- Preserve existing valid bookings where applicable.
- Notify affected customers.

FR9. Manual Booking Support

If permitted by the event organization, authorized staff shall be able to create a booking manually for special cases such as invited guests or offline sales

FR10. Category Performance

The system shall show which ticket categories are selling fastest. We can make the ticket price dynamic to increase the sale based on customer response.

FR11. Restrict Staff Access

Staff shall only be able to access functions relevant to their assigned role.

Non-Functional Requirements

NFR1. Performance

The system should respond to normal user requests within **2–3 seconds** under normal load.

NFR2. Scalability

The system should be able to handle a large number of users attempting to book tickets when a popular concert goes live.

NFR3. Availability

The system should remain available during important periods such as ticket-sale launches and event days.

NFR4. Reliability

The system should correctly maintain booking and ticket information without losing confirmed bookings.

NFR5. Security

The system shall protect user accounts, personal information, booking details, and payment-related information from unauthorized access.

NFR6. Authentication

Only authenticated and authorized users should be able to access protected management and administrative functions.

NFR7. Data Integrity

The system shall maintain consistent ticket availability and booking information and should prevent duplicate or conflicting bookings.

NFR8. Usability

The booking process should be simple and understandable so that a customer can find an event and complete a booking without unnecessary steps.

NFR9. Accessibility

The system should provide a readable and usable interface for users with different levels of technical ability.

NFR10. Maintainability

The system should be modular and structured so that new features, ticket categories, venues, and event types can be added without major changes to the entire system.

NFR11. Compatibility

The system should work correctly on commonly used **desktop and mobile browsers**.

NFR12. Backup and Recovery

The system should regularly back up important event, booking, and user data and provide a mechanism to recover data after a system failure.

NFR13. Auditability

The system should maintain records of important management activities such as event creation, price changes, cancellations, and rescheduling.

NFR14. Concurrent Access

The system should correctly handle multiple users accessing and booking tickets for the same concert simultaneously.

NFR15. Privacy

Customer information should only be accessible to users and staff who have the appropriate permissions.

Domain Requirements

DR1. Event Capacity

The system shall ensure that the total number of tickets issued for a concert does not exceed the maximum capacity approved for the venue or event.

DR2. Age Restrictions

If a concert has an age restriction, the system shall clearly display the restriction and enforce it where required.

DR3. Venue Capacity and Safety

The number of tickets available shall comply with the permitted capacity of the venue. The event manager should not be able to allocate more attendees to an area than its configured capacity.

DR4. Ticket Verification

A ticket must be verified before the customer is allowed entry to the concert. A successfully used ticket should not be accepted again.

DR5. Ticket Cancellation and Refund Rules

Ticket cancellations and refunds shall follow the cancellation and refund policy defined for the concert.

DR6. Event Rescheduling

If a concert is postponed or rescheduled, the system shall update the event date/time and inform customers with existing bookings. The system should maintain the relationship between the original booking and the rescheduled event.

DR7. Ticket Pricing Rules

Ticket prices shall be defined separately for different ticket categories. The system shall display the applicable price to the customer before payment. Any additional booking or service charges should be clearly shown before the customer confirms the payment.

5. Show Management

FRs

- The system shall allow an organizer to create a show listing with mandatory fields: title, performer(s)/cast, duration, age rating, language, and genre.
- The system shall route a new or edited show listing through a **Platform Admin approval step** before it becomes publicly visible, and shall notify the organizer of approval, rejection, or requested changes.
- The system shall allow organizers to upload and manage media assets (poster, trailer/promo video, performer bios) as part of a listing.
- The system shall let organizers save a listing as a **draft** before submitting it for approval.
- The system shall allow an organizer to **soft-block/hold a venue date** for a defined period before public confirmation, preventing other organizers from booking the same slot in that window.

- The system shall allow an organizer to **reschedule or cancel** a published show, and shall automatically trigger notification and refund/credit workflows for all existing ticket holders of that show.
- The system shall detect and warn the organizer of a **scheduling conflict** — same venue double-booked, or the same performer listed on overlapping showtimes across different listings — at the time of creating/editing a show.
- The system shall log the reason for any reschedule/cancellation (organizer-selected category: performer unavailability, low sales, venue issue, force majeure, other) for reporting and dispute resolution.
- The system shall allow organizers to define **multiple pricing tiers** (e.g., VIP, Premium, General) per show/session, each mapped to a seating zone or ticket category.
- The system shall support **dynamic/time-based pricing rules** (e.g., early-bird discount until a date, price increase as inventory depletes) configurable per show.
- The system shall support both **assigned/numbered seating** and **general admission** modes per show, selectable at listing time.
- The system shall allow the organizer to view (read-only, unless they are also the venue owner) the seating layout provided by the Venue Owner/Manager and map pricing tiers onto seating zones/blocks.
- The system shall allow the organizer to **reserve a defined block of seats** (e.g., press, sponsor, family) before public sale opens, excluding them from the sellable inventory count.
- The system shall provide a **real-time dashboard** showing seats sold, revenue-to-date, and remaining inventory per show and per session.
- The system shall provide sales breakdowns filterable by **ticket tier, showtime/session, and promo code used**.
- The system shall display **refund and cancellation rates** specific to the organizer's own shows, separate from platform-wide statistics.
- The system shall allow organizers to create and manage **promo codes** (percentage or flat discount, usage limit, validity window) for their own shows.

NFRs

- The real-time sales dashboard shall reflect a new booking within 5 seconds of transaction completion.
- Show listing creation/edit forms shall save a draft within 2 seconds and complete a full submission-for-approval within 5 seconds under normal load.
- The show management module shall be available 99.5% of the time, with scheduled maintenance excluded from peak listing/on-sale hours (typically evenings/weekends for live shows).
- Seat inventory, complimentary pass allocation, and reserved blocks shall be atomically deducted from sellable inventory to prevent overselling or double-allocation.
- Any reschedule/cancellation shall be reflected identically and simultaneously across the organizer dashboard, the registered-user booking view, and the refund/payment pipeline, with no more than a few seconds of propagation delay.
- An organizer shall only be able to view, edit, or report on shows they own; cross-organizer sales, pricing, and settlement data shall not be accessible even by direct URL/API manipulation.
- The scheduling-conflict detection engine shall perform conflict checks across all active venues and performers without perceptible delay (<1s) even as the number of concurrent shows on the platform grows.
- Settlement reports shall be exportable in formats (PDF/CSV) compatible with common accounting tools, since organizers currently reconcile manually outside the platform.
- Pricing tier and dynamic pricing rule configurations shall be defined through configurable rules rather than hard-coded logic, so new pricing models can be added without a code deployment.

6. Venue Manager

FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS (FR)

FR-VM-01

Requirement: The system shall allow a Venue Owner/Manager to create and maintain a venue profile including name, address, capacity, seating type, seating layout, amenities, and photos.

Priority: High

FR-VM-02

Requirement: The system shall allow a Venue Owner/Manager to mark specific dates as available or unavailable (blackout dates) on a venue calendar.

Priority: High

FR-VM-03

Requirement: The system shall allow an Organizer to view a venue's availability calendar and submit a booking request for a specific date.

Priority: High

FR-VM-04

Requirement: The system shall allow a Venue Owner/Manager to approve or reject an incoming booking request.

Priority: High

FR-VM-05

Requirement: The system shall automatically lock/block the requested date on the venue's calendar once a booking request is approved, to prevent double-booking.

Priority: High

FR-VM-06

Requirement: The system shall notify the Venue Owner/Manager when a new booking request is received.

Priority: Medium

FR-VM-07

Requirement: The system shall allow the Organizer to create a show/event listing only after the corresponding venue booking request has been approved.

Priority: High

FR-VM-08

Requirement: The system shall allow a Venue Owner/Manager to directly create a show/event listing for their own venue, for self-organized cases (e.g., cinemas where the venue owner is also the organizer).

Priority: Medium

NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS (NFR)

NFR-VM-01

Requirement: The system shall notify the Venue Owner/Manager of a new booking request within a few minutes of submission (near real-time notification).

Priority: Medium

NFR-VM-02

Requirement: The venue availability calendar shall be simple and clear enough for a non-technical user to operate without training.

Priority: High

NFR-VM-03

Requirement: The system shall be able to handle a venue's typical volume of booking requests (estimated low-to-moderate frequency per week) without performance degradation.

Priority: Medium

DOMAIN REQUIREMENTS

DR-VM-01

Requirement: A venue's listed capacity must comply with real-world constraints such as fire safety/occupancy limits.

Priority: Medium

DR-VM-02

Requirement: Pricing and contractual terms between the Venue Owner and Organizer are negotiated outside the system and are not stored or enforced by the

platform.

Priority: High

DR-VM-03

Requirement: A show/event listing cannot exist without an associated approved venue booking (except for self-organized venues, where the venue owner is also the organizer).

Priority: High

DR-VM-04

Requirement: Blackout dates set by the Venue Owner/Manager (e.g., maintenance, private events) must be respected by the system and cannot be requested by any Organizer.

Priority: Medium

7. Platform Admin

Functional Requirements (FRs)

FR-01: The system shall allow the Admin to view and search user, organizer, event, venue, booking, payment, and dispute records.

FR-02: The system shall allow the Admin to view and manage user and organizer account status, including approving, restricting, suspending, and reactivating accounts when authorized.

FR-03: The system shall allow the Admin to review organizer details and approve or reject organizer registration requests according to the platform's verification rules.

FR-04: The system shall allow the Admin to remove, deactivate, or flag an event listing when it violates platform rules or contains inappropriate, misleading, duplicate, or fraudulent information.

FR-05: The system shall allow the Admin to view event information provided by event managers and venue managers in order to identify inconsistencies in event, venue, schedule, and availability information.

FR-06: The system shall allow the Admin to view booking information associated with an event, including the customer, seat, booking status, payment status, and ticket status.

FR-7: The system shall allow the Admin to review refund requests escalated by Customer Care and approve or reject them according to the applicable cancellation and refund rules.

FR-8: The system shall allow the Admin to view payment transaction status received from the payment gateway and identify failed, pending, duplicated, or inconsistent transactions.

FR-9: The system shall allow the Admin to notify the appropriate stakeholder when an event, booking, dispute, refund, organizer account, or user account requires action or has been updated.

FR-10: The system shall provide the Admin with a centralized dashboard showing important platform information such as pending approvals, active events, booking issues, refunds, disputes, and critical alerts.

FR-11: The system shall allow the Admin to generate reports on users, organizers, events, bookings, cancellations, refunds, disputes, payments, and platform activity.

FR-12: The system shall allow the Admin to filter and search reports using relevant criteria such as date, event, venue, organizer, event type, and status.

FR-13: The system shall allow the Admin to view the history and current status of escalated issues from Customer Care, event managers, venue managers, and payment-related processes.

FR-14: The system shall record significant administrative actions, including account changes, event approval decisions, dispute resolutions, and refund decisions, in an audit log.

FR-15: The system shall allow the Admin to review conflicts between information provided by different stakeholders and record the final administrative decision or escalation.

Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs)

NFR-01: The Admin dashboard shall load the primary administrative information within 3 seconds under normal operating conditions.

NFR-02: Searches for users, organizers, events, bookings, venues, or transactions shall return results within 1 seconds under normal operating conditions.

NFR-03: Critical platform alerts related to booking, payment, or system failures shall be displayed to the Admin within 10 seconds of detection.

NFR-04: The system shall require successful authentication before any Admin function can be accessed.

NFR-05: The system shall implement role-based access control so that unauthorized Admin users cannot access restricted administrative functions or information.

NFR-06: Sensitive user, booking, and payment information shall be protected from unauthorized access.

NFR-07: Every significant administrative action shall record the Admin identity, action performed, affected record, date, and time.

NFR-08: The administrative interface shall remain available at least 99.5% of the time, excluding scheduled maintenance.

NFR-09: When an administrative operation fails, the system shall display an understandable error message and shall not partially apply the operation.

NFR-10: The system shall preserve administrative records and dispute histories so that authorized Admin users can retrieve the required information for investigation and resolution.

NFR-11: The system shall support increasing numbers of users, organizers, events, bookings, venues, and transactions without changing the basic Admin workflow.

NFR-12: The system shall prevent unauthorized changes to event, booking, payment, refund, and user information by enforcing appropriate permissions for every administrative operation.

NFR-13: The Admin interface shall provide sufficient information for investigating an escalated issue without requiring the Admin to access unrelated administrative sections unnecessarily.

8. Customer Care Agent

FRs

1. The system shall provide and allow customer care personnel to view relevant customer, booking, event, payment status info. to investigate the issue.
2. The system shall support escalation of the issues that can't be resolved by customer care to appropriate stakeholders.
3. The system shall maintain the information required by Customer Care to review the history of an ongoing customer issue.
4. The system shall allow Customer Care personnel to view customer issues that require further action or follow-up.
5. The system shall maintain the history of actions and updates associated with a customer issue.

NFRs

1. Customer Care shall only be able to access customer and transaction information required for their support responsibilities.
2. The system shall notify Customer Care of newly assigned or escalated
3. customer issues within 30 seconds.
4. The information required to investigate a customer issue should be presented clearly so that Customer Care can find it without unnecessary navigation.
5. Customer issue records shall not be lost or unintentionally modified while an issue is being handled.
6. Customer Care functions should remain available whenever the ticket-booking service is operational

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- Customer issues shall be resolved within the response/resolution time defined by the organization's support policy.

9. Payment Gateway

Functional Requirements: Payment Gateway

A. Transaction Processing

- **FR-01:** The system shall initiate a payment request to the gateway with order amount, currency, and a unique order ID.
- **FR-02:** The system shall redirect/embed the gateway's checkout interface to collect payment details (card, UPI, wallet, net banking) without the platform storing raw card data.
- **FR-03:** The system shall receive and process a real-time payment status response (success, failure, pending) from the gateway.
- **FR-04:** The system shall support multiple payment modes as exposed by the gateway (Credit/Debit Card, UPI, Net Banking, Wallets, EMI).

B. Callback & Webhook Handling

- **FR-05:** The system shall expose a callback/webhook endpoint to receive asynchronous payment confirmation from the gateway.
- **FR-06:** The system shall verify the authenticity of a webhook using the gateway's signature/HMAC verification method before trusting the payload.
- **FR-07:** The system shall handle duplicate webhook notifications idempotently (no double-booking of tickets on repeated callbacks).

C. Refunds & Cancellations

- **FR-08:** The system shall initiate a full or partial refund request to the gateway when a user cancels a booking.
- **FR-09:** The system shall track and display refund status (initiated, processed, failed) as reported by the gateway.

D. Order & Transaction Reconciliation

- **FR-10:** The system shall store a gateway-generated transaction/payment ID against every booking for reconciliation.

- **FR-11:** The system shall support a reconciliation report/API to match platform-side bookings against gateway-side settlement reports.

E. Failure Handling

- **FR-12:** The system shall detect a failed or timed-out payment and release the temporarily held seat/ticket inventory.
- **FR-13:** The system shall allow the user to retry payment through an alternate mode if the first attempt fails.

F. Settlement

- **FR-14:** The system shall receive settlement reports from the gateway reflecting funds transferred to the platform's bank account, net of gateway fees.

Non-Functional Requirements — Payment Gateway

A. Security & Compliance

- **NFR-1:** The system shall maintain an immutable audit log of all payment-related API calls (request, response, timestamp) for a minimum retention period required by compliance/regulatory bodies.
- **NFR-2:** The system shall detect and block replay attacks by validating request timestamps/nonces on gateway callbacks.
- **NFR-03:** The system shall comply with RBI guidelines (for India) on tokenization for saved card details.

B. Performance

- **NFR-04:** The system shall receive a payment status response from the gateway within an acceptable timeout window (e.g., 15–30 seconds) before flagging it as pending/failed.
- **NFR-05:** The checkout redirect/embed shall load within 2 seconds under normal network conditions.

C. Reliability & Availability

- **NFR-06:** The system shall gracefully handle gateway downtime by queuing/retrying webhook processing rather than losing transaction data.
- **NFR-07:** The gateway integration shall maintain 99.9% availability alignment, matching the SLA committed by the payment provider.

D. Scalability

- **NFR-08:** The system shall support high transaction concurrency during peak booking windows (e.g., blockbuster ticket releases) without gateway-side rate-limiting causing failures.

E. Auditability

- **NFR-09:** The system shall log every transaction request/response (excluding sensitive card data) for audit and dispute resolution.

F. Data Integrity

- **NFR-10:** The system shall ensure a booking is only confirmed after a verified successful payment signal, never optimistically before confirmation.

10. Review Aggregators

Functional Requirements:

A. Authoring & Publishing

- **FR-01:** The system shall allow a verified film critic to create, edit, and publish a review linked to a specific film entry.
- **FR-02:** The system shall allow the critic to save a review as a draft before publishing.
- **FR-03:** The system shall allow the critic to schedule a review for automatic publishing at a future date/time (e.g., aligned with release day).

- **FR-04:** The system shall allow the critic to edit a review after publishing and display an "edited on [date]" indicator.
- **FR-05:** The system shall allow the critic to delete/unpublish their own review.

B. Rating & Scoring

- **FR-06:** The system shall allow the critic to assign a numeric or star-based rating to a film alongside the written review.
- **FR-07:** The system shall allow the platform to aggregate individual critic ratings into an overall "Critic Score" for each film (e.g., Tomatometer-style).
- **FR-08:** The system shall allow the critic to choose a rating scale format (e.g., out of 5, out of 10, percentage) if the platform supports multiple.

C. Content Structure

- **FR-09:** The system shall allow the critic to structure a review into tagged sub-sections (Story, Direction, Performances, Cinematography, Music, Verdict).
- **FR-10:** The system shall enforce or suggest a minimum/maximum word count for reviews, based on critic/platform preference.
- **FR-11:** The system shall allow the critic to write a short one-line summary/verdict in addition to the full review.

D. Spoiler Management

- **FR-12:** The system shall allow the critic to mark specific sections or the entire review as containing spoilers.
- **FR-13:** The system shall visually hide/blur spoiler-marked content until the reader explicitly chooses to reveal it.

E. Media Attachment

- **FR-14:** The system shall allow the critic to embed a trailer link, images, or video clips within a review.

- **FR-15:** The system shall allow the critic to attach a personal profile photo/byline to their published reviews.

F. Credibility & Verification

- **FR-16:** The system shall display a "Verified Critic" badge on reviews authored by an approved/verified critic.
- **FR-17:** The system shall allow the critic to maintain a public profile listing their past reviews and average rating pattern.

G. Reader Engagement

- **FR-18:** The system shall allow readers to comment on a critic's review.
- **FR-19:** The system shall allow the critic to reply to or pin specific reader comments on their review.
- **FR-20:** The system shall allow readers to like/upvote a critic's review.

H. Discovery & Comparison

- **FR-21:** The system shall display critic reviews alongside general user/audience reviews on the same film page, clearly labeled as separate.
- **FR-22:** The system shall allow filtering/sorting of reviews by critic, rating, or publish date on a film's page.
- **FR-23:** The system shall allow the critic to publish ranked lists or comparison articles (e.g., "Top 10 films of the year") independent of a single film page.

I. Analytics

- **FR-24:** The system shall provide the critic with basic analytics on their reviews (views, likes, shares, comments).

Non-Functional Requirements

A. Performance

- **NFR-01:** The system shall load a critic's review page within 2 seconds under normal network conditions.
- **NFR-02:** The system shall support publishing of a review (text + media) within 5 seconds of the critic clicking "Publish."
- **NFR-03:** The system shall handle at least 500 concurrent critics editing/publishing reviews without noticeable degradation.

B. Usability

- **NFR-04:** The review editor shall provide a distraction-free writing interface (rich text formatting: bold, italics, headings, bullet points).
- **NFR-05:** The system shall auto-save drafts every 30 seconds to prevent loss of work.
- **NFR-06:** The interface shall require no more than 3 clicks for a critic to go from login to publishing a review.
- **NFR-07:** The system shall provide a live word-count and reading-time estimate while the critic writes.

C. Reliability & Availability

- **NFR-08:** The system shall guarantee 99.5% uptime for the critique/review module.
- **NFR-09:** The system shall not lose a critic's draft even if the browser/app crashes mid-edit (recovery from auto-save).
- **NFR-10:** Scheduled reviews (FR-03) shall publish within ± 1 minute of the scheduled time with 99.9% reliability.

D. Security

- **NFR-11:** The system shall restrict review editing/deletion rights to the original critic (or an authorized editor/admin) only.
- **NFR-12:** The system shall use secure authentication (e.g., OAuth/2FA) for verified critic accounts, given their public credibility badge.

- **NFR-13:** The system shall encrypt any critic payment/earnings data (if premium content model exists) in transit and at rest.

E. Scalability

- **NFR-14:** The system shall support a growing number of critics (from tens to thousands) without requiring architectural changes.
- **NFR-15:** The system shall support review content in multiple media formats (text, audio, video) without significant performance impact as volume grows.

F. Data Integrity & Consistency

- **NFR-16:** The system shall ensure that an edited review's version history (FR-28) is never lost or overwritten.
- **NFR-17:** The system shall ensure a review's aggregated critic score (FR-07) recalculates accurately and consistently whenever a new critic rating is added or edited.

G. Accessibility

- **NFR-18:** The review interface shall comply with WCAG 2.1 AA standards (screen-reader compatibility, keyboard navigation, alt-text support).
- **NFR-19:** Spoiler-hidden content (FR-13) shall remain accessible to screen readers via appropriate ARIA labeling, without revealing spoilers visually.

H. Maintainability

- **NFR-20:** The review module's codebase shall be modular enough that adding a new content type (e.g., a new media format) doesn't require rewriting the core publishing flow.
- **NFR-21:** The system shall log all editorial actions (approvals, rejections, edits) for auditability and debugging.

I. Compatibility

- **NFR-22:** The critic dashboard shall be responsive and function correctly across desktop, tablet, and mobile browsers.
- **NFR-23:** Exported review files (PDF/plain text, FR-32) shall render correctly across standard readers (Adobe Acrobat, browser PDF viewers).

J. Legal & Compliance

- **NFR-24:** The system shall retain published reviews and their edit history for a minimum legally/contractually required period (e.g., for copyright or dispute purposes).
- **NFR-25:** The plagiarism check (FR-42) shall complete within an acceptable time (e.g., under 10 seconds) without blocking the publishing workflow indefinitely.